

Question:

A 2-year-old boy is brought to the physician for a well-child examination. Since infancy, he has frequently had large-volume stools that are loose and greasy. He was treated for otitis media twice in the past year. He has a history of recurrent respiratory tract infections since birth. He is at the 5th percentile for height and 3rd percentile for weight. Vital signs are within normal limits. Examination shows softening of the occipital and parietal bones. Scattered expiratory wheezing and rhonchi are heard throughout both lung fields. Which of the following is the most likely cause of this patient's symptoms? Answer Choices: A. Deficient $\alpha 1$ antitrypsin B. CFTR gene mutation C. Absent T cells D. Impaired ciliary function

Reasoning + Answer:

<think> Given the presence of greasy stools, respiratory issues, and developmental lag, indicating potential issues with lung and intestinal health from birth, suggesting a condition like cystic fibrosis that affects epithelial function, particularly in glands producing mucus, leading to such symptoms. </think> <answer> Deficient $\alpha 1$ antitrypsin </answer>

